BATMAN: THE LONG HALLOWEEN

Details **Originally published** Batman: The Long Halloween #1-13 (1996-97) **Publisher** DC **Writer** Jeph Loeb **Artist** Tim Sale **Collected in** Absolute Batman: The Long Halloween **Available digitally** TBC

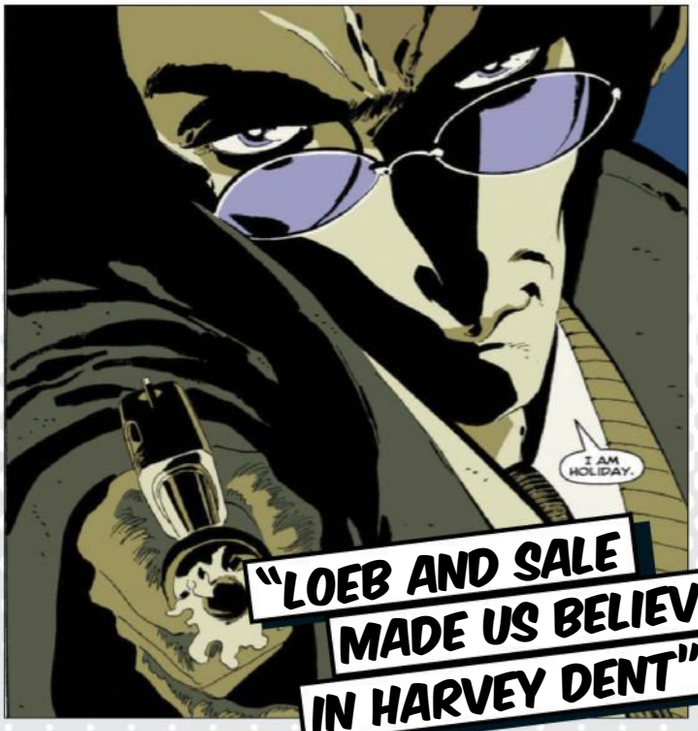
Retelling an origin story can be a tricky business, but Jeph Loeb and Tim Sale's *Batman: The Long Halloween* filters Harvey Dent's transformation through classic gangster movies and hard-boiled murder mysteries to create Two-Face's finest tale.

With a killer picking off Gotham's many mobsters, Dent, Batman and Jim Gordon race to find the man (or woman) responsible before a gang war begins. The story is so deeply steeped in *The Godfather* (Carmine Falcone is essentially a skinnier Don Corleone who has to deal with comic-book villains) and James Cagney-style tough guys that *The Long Halloween* veers towards pastiche, but Sale's artwork beautifully renders Gotham as a gloriously Thirties gangland Chicago.

It's not all about the gangsters, though. Sale's Joker is a fantastically toothy, wiry creation, and Loeb never loses sight of the fact that is a *Batman* story. Finally, it's the slow destruction of the central trio that makes *The Long Halloween* so powerful, as Christopher Nolan understood when he borrowed it for *The Dark Knight*. Loeb and Sale make us believe in Harvey Dent – and then they break him.







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